

Heirs' Property Indicators for Hopewell

Richmond MSA heirs' property study. Locality fact sheet.



Heirs' property can arise when real estate passes to family members after an owner dies without a clear transfer of title. When an estate is never formally settled, ownership can splinter across descendants while the deed remains unchanged. Without a clear title, families may struggle to sell or refinance the home, borrow against it for repairs, obtain disaster-recovery assistance, or pass it on to others.

This sheet summarizes the heirs' property indicators found across Hopewell's parcels, read from public records. The result is a regional screen identifying parcels with an elevated risk of being an heirs' property, not a legal determination of title. The numbers below show how many parcels were flagged, how they compare to the rest of the local parcel stock, and where in Hopewell they cluster.

FLAGGED PARCELS

388

of 10,358 parcels

SHARE OF PARCEL STOCK

3.75%

study area 2.12%

CONFIDENCE TIERS

118 / 270

high confidence / likely

CLUSTER TRACTS

1 hot / 0 cold

of 7 census tracts

Flagged Parcels vs. All Parcel Stock

Hopewell

	FLAGGED	ALL STOCK
Median assessed value	\$112,700	\$139,000
Median build year	1956	1962
USPS vacancy, known status	26.84%	4.24%

Study Area for Comparison

Richmond MSA study area, 8,091 flagged of 381,852 parcels

	FLAGGED	ALL STOCK
Median assessed value	\$245,700	\$329,000
Median build year	1965	1981
USPS vacancy, known status	9.55%	1.03%

Ownership Signals

Share of flagged parcels carrying each signal

Deceased owner of record		69.3%
Long tenure		71.9%
Absentee owner		51.3%
Out-of-state owner		9.5%

Property Type Mix

Share of flagged parcels by type

Occupied family home		48.2%
Multi-owner absentee home		13.4%
Empty lot		14.9%
Vacant house		23.5%

Flag counts reflect indicator-based screening of parcel records, not legal determinations of title. Totals are best read as a floor, not a ceiling.

Vacancy is the share of parcels with a known USPS vacancy status. Parcels with no status on record are excluded from the denominator.

Property types are groupings of statistically similar parcels. No single trait defines membership.

Hot- and cold-cluster tracts have flagged-parcel rates statistically above or below the regional pattern. Tracts with fewer than 5 heirs-flagged parcels or fewer than 100 total parcels are not assigned a rate class. 1 of 7 tracts here are below that threshold.

High confidence indicates stronger, converging heirs' property evidence. Likely indicates meaningful but less conclusive evidence. Both are classifications, not legal determinations of heirs' property status.